

TIMELINE

The Ancient Greek civilization existed for 2,500 years. The Greeks built huge city-states, formed new colonies, and fought many battles before they were finally conquered by the Romans.

2200–1450 BCE
Height of Minoan palace culture in Crete.



Model of a Minoan house

1450 BCE
Mycenaeans invade Crete and occupy the Minoan palaces. They also build their own palace settlements in the Peloponnese region.



Fortified palace of Mycenae

1350 BCE
At the peak of the Mycenaean period, the city of Mycenae has a population of around 30,000.

Greek soldiers hid in a wooden horse to defeat the Trojans

1184 BCE
According to Homer, Greece defeats Troy in a war that has lasted more than ten years.



2500 BCE

MINOAN PERIOD
2500–1600 BCE

Minoan civilization flourishes in Crete. The Minoans are clever traders and build large palace complexes, but these are destroyed by invaders.

MYCENAEAN PERIOD
1600–1200 BCE

The Mycenaeans build fortified palaces. Armed with bronze weapons, they expand into Crete, but their cities fall to new invaders from the north.

DARK AGES
1200–800 BCE

The Mycenaean culture collapses around 1200 BCE, and Greece enters a dark age. Settlements become smaller and there are no written records.

Ancient Greece

The Greeks were one of the most advanced civilizations in the ancient world, inventing politics, philosophy, theatre, athletics, and the study of history. Their stories and plays still exist today, along with the remains of beautiful temples and buildings.



CITY-STATES

For most of its history, Ancient Greece was divided into city-states. Each city ruled the villages and farmlands around it with their own system of government and chose one god as a special protector.

WARRING STATES

The city-states of Athens and Sparta were bitter rivals and fought several wars against each other.

THE CITY-STATE OF ATHENS WAS 20 TIMES LARGER THAN THE SMALLEST GREEK COMMUNITIES

DAILY LIFE

Farmers and fishermen provided food, while in the city, traders sold leather goods, pots, weapons, and jewellery. Well-born women ran the household, helped by slaves.



SILVER ATHENIAN COIN



COIN FROM KNOSSOS



GOLD ALEXANDRIAN COIN



FISH PLATE



REPLICA OF A GREEK PENDANT



GOLD EARRING



SMALL POT FOR OIL OR PERFUME



WINE JUG



CLASSICAL OIL POT



MODELS DRESSED AS ANCIENT GREEKS



SANDAL-SHAPED PERFUME BOTTLE



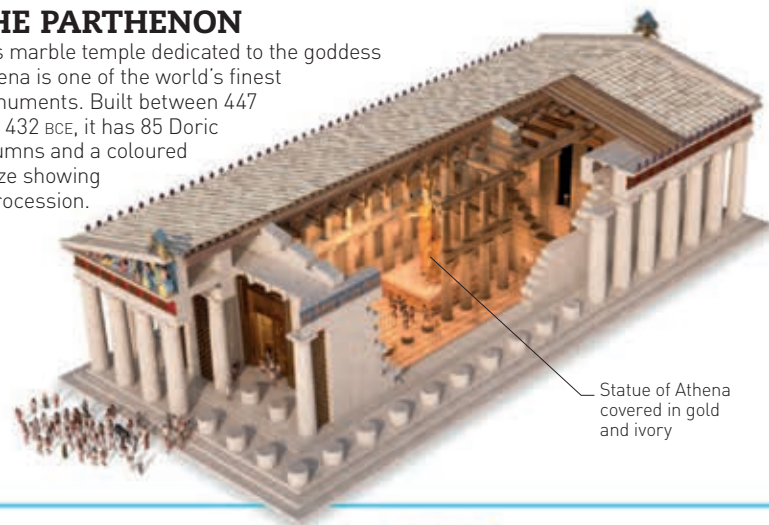
POWDER BOX



EARTHENWARE COOKING STOVE

THE PARTHENON

This marble temple dedicated to the goddess Athena is one of the world's finest monuments. Built between 447 and 432 BCE, it has 85 Doric columns and a coloured frieze showing a procession.



Statue of Athena covered in gold and ivory

OLYMPIC GAMES

The Olympic Games were held in honour of the god Zeus. They took place every fourth year from 776 BCE at a site called Olympia.



DAY 1
On the first day of the games, competitors and judges swore an oath to compete fairly, and boys took part in running and boxing contests.



DAY 2
The second day was for chariot and horse races and the pentathlon – long jump, discus, javelin, running, and wrestling.



DAY 3
On the third day, 100 oxen were sacrificed to Zeus. Running races included the 200-metre "stade" race – the oldest contest in the games.



DAY 4
Wrestling and boxing filled the fourth day. Pankration was a kind of wrestling in which kicking and strangling were allowed.



DAY 5
On the final day, the winning athletes went to the Temple of Zeus to be crowned with olive wreaths.